



General Customer Notes and special case: out-of-province pickup orders.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

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1. Purpose

This SOP documents how Customer Success handles a recurring special case: pickup orders for customers located outside Quebec. Shopify's official pickup option recalculates taxes based on the Montreal head-office location and applies Quebec GST and QST, which produces an incorrect total for out-of-province buyers. The SOP also captures the broader expectation that customer-specific notes in Shopify and in the customer-profiles document are checked before any order is processed.

2. Scope

Applies to every Customer Success representative who creates, edits, or invoices Shopify orders. Applies to any order flagged as pickup where the customer is not a Quebec resident and is arranging their own transportation. Out of scope: ordinary shipped orders that use carrier-calculated rates, and pickup orders where the customer is located in Quebec (Quebec taxes apply correctly in that case).

3. Customer-specific account notes

A small number of accounts have specific handling rules that override the general flow. Before processing an order, the representative checks two sources of customer-specific instructions.

Customer Profiles & Order Details document

- **Location:** P:\Emna\Copy of Customer Profiles & Order Details.
- Examples of rules captured there: invoicing every Friday, agreed shipping amounts, mandatory notes to add to Shopify orders, and approved payment methods.
- Related document: SOP-CS-003 Payment terms and order verification covers a portion of this same territory and is consulted alongside.

Shopify customer notes

- Open the customer's profile in Shopify and read the Notes panel before any order action.
- The account name and the day-to-day contact are not always the same person. For example, the account may be registered to Amaan Panjwani while the purchasing manager is Dan.
- Notes also capture the best time of day to call, who is in on which days, whether the customer prefers phone or email, and alternate phone numbers.
- Communicate with the Account Manager assigned to the customer; they hold context that is not always written down.

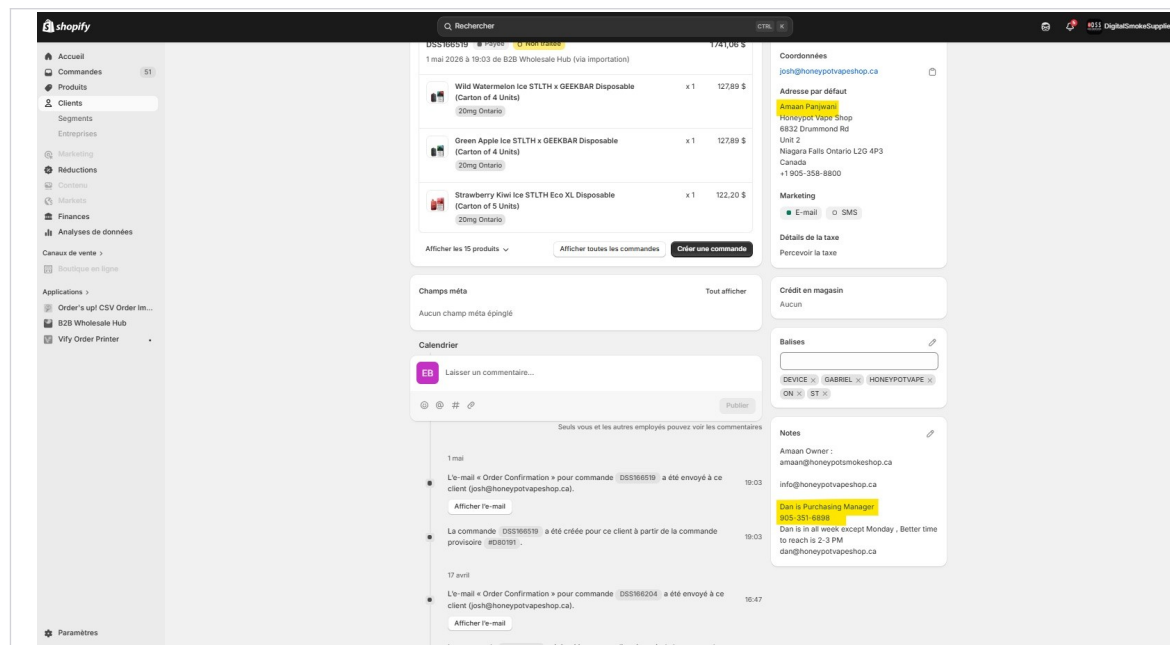


Figure 1 — Shopify customer profile showing the Notes panel with the purchasing manager, best contact times, and an alternate email for an account whose registered name differs from the day-to-day contact.

4. Special case: Tax behaviour for pickup orders

When an order is set to Pickup from Montreal head office, Shopify automatically applies Quebec GST and QST based on the fulfilment location, not the customer's province. This changes the final order total and produces an incorrect tax amount for any buyer outside Quebec.

Tax rule

Selecting Shopify's official "Pickup from Head Office" option forces Quebec taxes on the order regardless of the customer's billing or shipping address. Never use the official pickup option for an out-of-province

customer.

5. Correct workflow — custom shipping method

Use a custom shipping method instead of Shopify's official pickup option. The custom method leaves the tax calculation tied to the customer's address, which produces the correct tax structure for the buyer's province.

1. Create the order in Shopify as normal, with the customer's correct shipping address selected.
2. At the shipping-method step, select Custom Shipping Method, set it at \$0.00, and name it **Pickup – Head Office**. Do not select the system-generated "Pickup from Head Office" option.
3. Confirm that the tax line on the order matches the customer's province (for example, HST 13 percent for Ontario) and not Quebec GST plus QST.
4. Add the order note **This order is for pickup.** in the Shopify order so the warehouse team knows the order is not to be shipped, even though the shipping method is no longer labelled "Pickup" by Shopify.
5. Save the order and proceed to invoicing.

6. Payment options when the order is unpaid

If the customer has not paid at the time the tax correction is made, offer the approved alternative payment methods. This came up in the Paul Counsell case because the customer had exceeded the limit on his credit card.

- Credit card.
- E-transfer.
- Bank deposit.
- Other payment methods approved under SOP-CS-003 Payment terms and order verification.

Attach the DSS Payment Information PDF to the email so the customer has the account details for e-transfer or bank deposit.

7. Customer communication and transparency

Tax adjustments, total changes, and shipping-method changes are never made silently. The customer receives a written explanation covering what changed and why, before the new invoice is sent.

Transparency rule

Never silently modify taxes, totals, or shipping methods. Always explain why the change was made, how taxes are calculated, and why the total changed. Cancel the previous invoice and issue a new one rather than editing the original in place.

The email below is the reference template. The representative adapts the wording to the specific customer but keeps the same four elements: acknowledge the customer's observation, explain why the original total was wrong, confirm the cancellation and reissue, and offer the alternative payment methods.

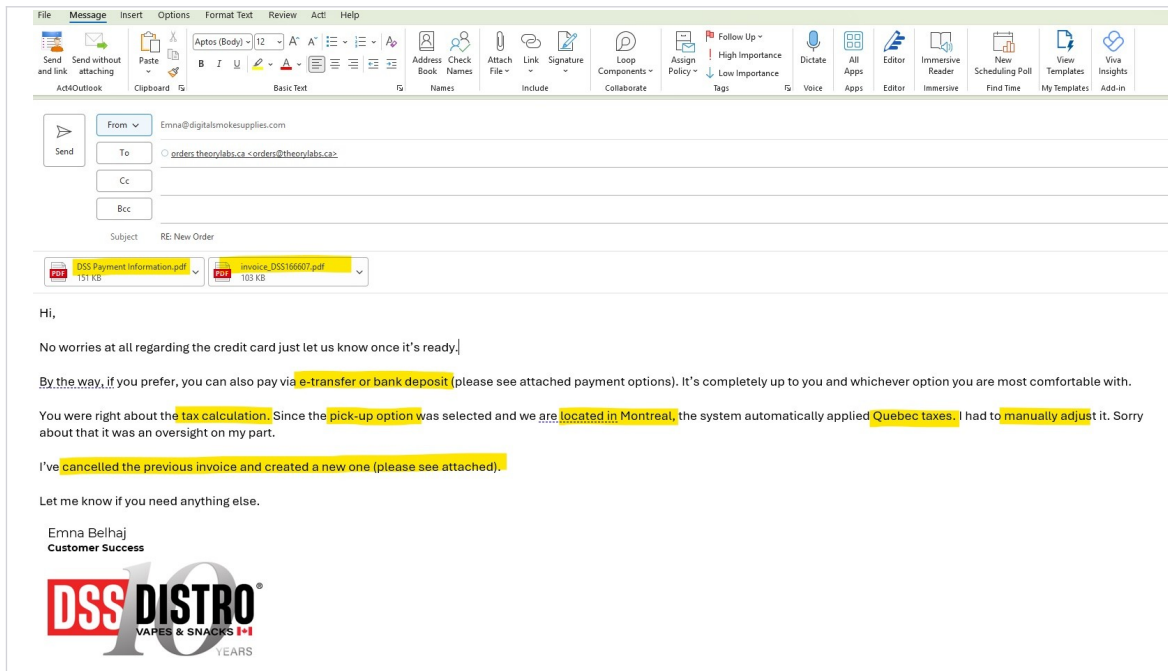
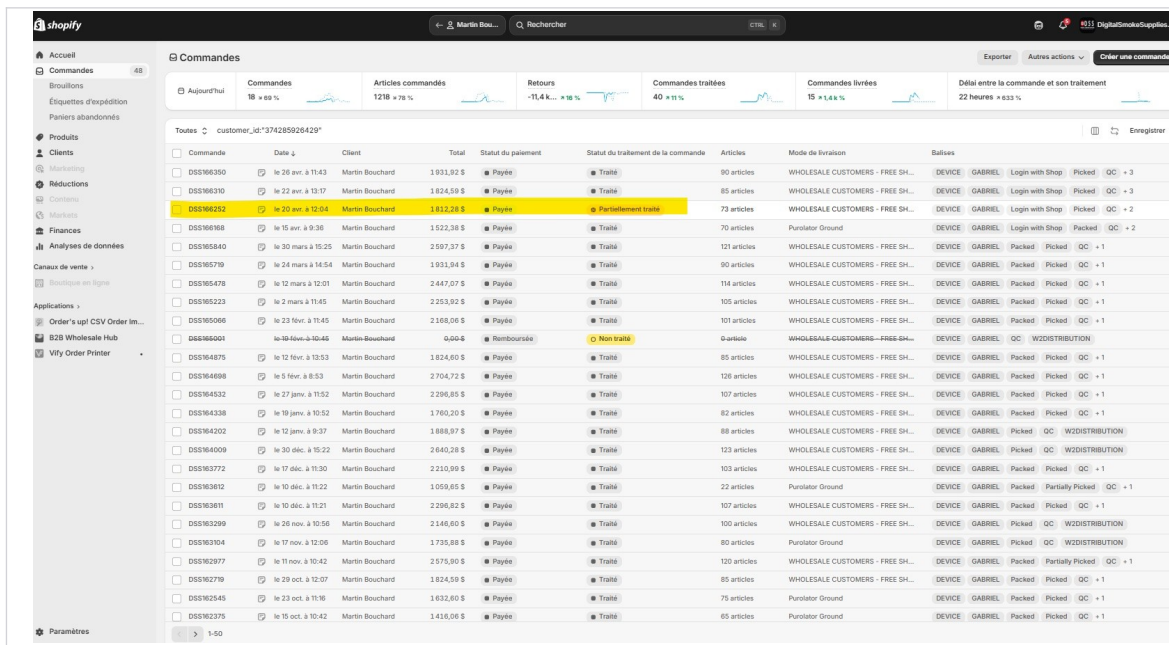


Figure 2 — Reference email sent after the manual tax correction. The reply acknowledges the customer was right, explains why Shopify applied Quebec taxes, confirms the previous invoice was cancelled and reissued, and attaches the DSS Payment Information PDF.

8. Documentation in Shopify

Every change made to a pickup order is recorded in the Shopify order timeline and in the customer notes so the next representative sees the history without needing to ask.

- Add the pickup order note **This order is for pickup.** to every pickup order, regardless of shipping method selected.
- Record the tax adjustment in the order comments with a brief explanation of the customer's province and the corrected tax line.
- If the cancellation-and-reissue flow is used, link the new invoice number in the order timeline so the trail is traceable.
- Update the customer's Notes panel if a recurring instruction emerges (for example, a customer who consistently arranges their own pickup transport).



Commande	Date	Client	Total	Statut du paiement	Statut du traitement de la commande	Articles	Mode de livraison	Balisages
DSS96390	le 26 av. à 11:43	Martin Bouchard	1 031,92 \$	Payé	Traité	90 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Login with Shop Picked QC + 3
DSS96390	le 22 av. à 13:17	Martin Bouchard	1 824,59 \$	Payé	Traité	85 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Login with Shop Picked QC + 3
DSS96392	le 20 av. à 12:54	Martin Bouchard	1 812,28 \$	Payé	Partiellement traité	73 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Login with Shop Picked QC + 2
DSS96398	le 15 av. à 9:36	Martin Bouchard	1 122,38 \$	Payé	Traité	70 articles	Purulator Ground	DEVICE GABRIEL Login with Shop Picked QC + 2
DSS96340	le 30 mars à 15:25	Martin Bouchard	2 597,37 \$	Payé	Traité	121 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS96379	le 24 mars à 14:54	Martin Bouchard	1 931,94 \$	Payé	Traité	90 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS963478	le 12 mars à 12:01	Martin Bouchard	2 447,07 \$	Payé	Traité	114 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS963223	le 2 mars à 11:45	Martin Bouchard	2 253,02 \$	Payé	Traité	105 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS963066	le 23 fév. à 11:45	Martin Bouchard	2 168,06 \$	Payé	Traité	101 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS963001	le 19 fév. à 10:45	Martin Bouchard	940,40 \$	Remboursé	Non traité	0 article	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL QC W/DISTRIBUTION
DSS964875	le 12 nov. à 12:53	Martin Bouchard	1 824,60 \$	Payé	Traité	85 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS964898	le 5 fév. à 9:53	Martin Bouchard	2 704,72 \$	Payé	Traité	128 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS964332	le 27 jan. à 11:52	Martin Bouchard	2 296,85 \$	Payé	Traité	107 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS964338	le 19 jan. à 10:52	Martin Bouchard	1 760,20 \$	Payé	Traité	82 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS964202	le 12 jan. à 9:37	Martin Bouchard	1 888,97 \$	Payé	Traité	88 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked QC W/DISTRIBUTION
DSS964009	le 30 déc. à 15:22	Martin Bouchard	2 640,28 \$	Payé	Traité	123 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked QC W/DISTRIBUTION
DSS963772	le 17 déc. à 11:30	Martin Bouchard	2 210,99 \$	Payé	Traité	103 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS963612	le 10 déc. à 11:22	Martin Bouchard	1 059,65 \$	Payé	Traité	22 articles	Purulator Ground	DEVICE GABRIEL Partially Picked QC + 1
DSS963611	le 10 déc. à 11:21	Martin Bouchard	2 296,82 \$	Payé	Traité	107 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS963299	le 26 nov. à 10:56	Martin Bouchard	2 148,60 \$	Payé	Traité	100 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked QC W/DISTRIBUTION
DSS963104	le 17 nov. à 12:06	Martin Bouchard	1 735,88 \$	Payé	Traité	80 articles	Purulator Ground	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked QC W/DISTRIBUTION
DSS962977	le 11 nov. à 12:42	Martin Bouchard	2 575,90 \$	Payé	Traité	120 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Partially Picked QC + 1
DSS962719	le 29 oct. à 12:07	Martin Bouchard	1 824,59 \$	Payé	Traité	85 articles	WHOLESALE CUSTOMERS - FREE SH...	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS962545	le 23 oct. à 11:16	Martin Bouchard	1 632,60 \$	Payé	Traité	75 articles	Purulator Ground	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1
DSS962375	le 15 oct. à 10:42	Martin Bouchard	1 416,06 \$	Payé	Traité	65 articles	Purulator Ground	DEVICE GABRIEL Picked Picked QC + 1

Figure 3 — Customer order history in Shopify with a partially fulfilled order highlighted. Order history and status flags are reviewed for context before any tax or shipping adjustment is made.

9. Key takeaway

Pickup orders for customers outside Quebec require a manual workflow. The two non-negotiables are: use a custom shipping method instead of Shopify's official pickup option, and explain every change to the customer in writing before the new invoice is sent.

- Avoid Shopify's official pickup option when it would apply Quebec taxes incorrectly.
- Use a custom shipping method named **Pickup – Head Office** instead.
- Mark the order **This order is for pickup.** in the notes so the warehouse team is informed.
- Document every change in the order timeline and the customer's Notes panel.
- Communicate transparently with the customer about what changed and why.

Non-Compliance

Using Shopify's official pickup option for an out-of-province customer produces an incorrect tax total and exposes DSS to a tax remittance error. The representative who issued the invoice is responsible for cancelling the incorrect invoice, reissuing the corrected one, and notifying the customer in writing the same business day the error is identified. Repeated occurrences of the same error by the same representative are reviewed by the Customer Success Lead and may be escalated to a coaching plan. Silent tax or total adjustments made without customer notification are treated as a breach of the transparency rule and are corrected by sending a follow-up explanation within one business day of detection.

Exceptions

The Customer Success Lead may approve use of Shopify's official pickup option for a Quebec-based customer arranging their own transport, since Quebec taxes apply correctly in that case. Any other deviation — for example, applying Quebec taxes deliberately to an out-of-province order at the customer's written request — requires written approval from the Customer Success Lead and a note in both the order timeline and the customer's Shopify Notes panel explaining the basis for the exception.